

Tell us how you run your shop

We are building your platform around how your office actually works — your funnel, your words, your residual process — rather than bending your business to fit generic CRM. These questions are how we find out. Your answers decide what we turn on for you on day one, and what we build next.

WHO SHOULD FILL THIS IN

Whoever runs the sales floor, plus whoever reconciles residuals. Those are usually two people, and the second half of this matters most.

HOW LONG IT TAKES

About 25 minutes. Skip anything that does not apply to you — a blank is an answer.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

We turn your answers into a build plan and walk you through it: what ships first, what comes later, and what we would not build at all.

Two notes before you start.

- Where we have offered checkboxes, tick as many as are true — and write in the margin when none of them is quite right. The write-ins are the most useful thing in here.
- Do not tidy up your answers. If the honest answer is "a spreadsheet nobody but Karen understands", that is exactly what we need to see.

01 Your business

The shape of the company, so we size everything else correctly.

Q1 How would you describe your business to another person in the industry?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Registered ISO / MSP | ☐ Payment facilitator |
| ☐ Agent office under an ISO | ☐ A mix of the above |
| ☐ Sub-ISO | ☐ Something else (please say) |

Q2 Which processors or back-ends do you board merchants to?

List all of them, even the one you only use twice a year. Each one is a different report format and a different set of rules on our side.

Q3 Roughly how many merchants are on your books today, and how many people sell for you?

Ballpark is fine. We are asking because forty reps and four reps are genuinely different products.

02 Your words

The app calls things whatever you call them — the menu, the buttons, the page titles. So we need your vocabulary, not ours.

Q4 What do you call the person at the business you are selling to?

- | | |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| ☐ Owner | ☐ Contact |
| ☐ Principal | ☐ Signer |
| ☐ Merchant | ☐ Other: |
-

Q5 Walk us through a deal from first contact to the merchant's first batch. What are the stages, and what do you call each one?

This becomes the board your reps drag deals across, so please use your own stage names — even if there are nine of them.

Q6 Tell us about your reps.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ W-2 employees | ☐ We have sub-agents under agents |
| ☐ 1099 independent agents | ☐ Reps would log in themselves |
| ☐ Both | ☐ Only the office logs in |

If you have sub-agents: how many levels deep does it go, and does a top-level agent see their sub-agents' merchants?

Q7 On a proposal, what do you call the person who presents it, and the person responsible for the account afterwards?

For example "Rep" and "Relationship manager", or "Agent" and "Account executive". They may well be the same person — say so if they are.

03 Selling

What a rep actually carries into a shop, and what comes back out.

Q8 What do you call the document you put in front of a merchant to win the deal?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Proposal | ☐ Statement analysis |
| ☐ Savings analysis | ☐ Quote |
| ☐ Rate comparison | ☐ Other: |
-

Q9 When one business has several locations, how do you think about it — one merchant with several accounts, or several merchants?

We want to put the volume, the rates and the residual in the right place, and that depends entirely on your answer here.

Q10 What do you need to know about a merchant account itself, beyond who the business is?

MID, MCC, open date, average ticket, monthly volume, card-present versus e-commerce, current pricing — tick or list whatever you look up most often.

Q11 How does hardware work for you?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ We sell terminals outright | ☐ The merchant brings their own |
| ☐ We lease them | ☐ We hold stock ourselves |
| ☐ We place them free | ☐ A distributor ships direct |
-

Q12 Do you need to know which specific unit is sitting at which merchant — by serial number?

In other words: when a terminal comes back, does anyone care which one it was?

Q13 Do you ever send a merchant a bill you expect them to pay you directly?

Most ISOs never do — the fees come out of the merchant's deposits. But equipment, software or a service plan sometimes gets invoiced. If you never invoice anyone, say so and we will leave that whole area out.

04 Getting a merchant live

Everything between a signature and a first batch.

Q14 What paperwork does an application need, and where does it live today while you are collecting it?

Signed app, statements, voided check, ID, business licence — and honestly: email inbox, a shared drive, a filing cabinet?

Q15 After a merchant is live, what do they call you about, and who picks up the phone?

Chargebacks, a deposit that did not land, a dead terminal, a fee they do not recognise — and what you call that queue internally.

Q16 Would you ever want merchants themselves to log in — to see statements, open a ticket, or check a deposit?

☐ Yes, that would be valuable

☐ No — we would rather they call us

☐ Maybe later

Q17 Who inside your office should *not* be able to see something?

This is the most important question on the page. For example: should a rep be able to see another rep's merchants? Their residuals? Should a support person see commission splits? Tell us what would cause a problem if the wrong person saw it.

05 Residuals and getting paid

This is the part we most want to get right, because it is the part that happens every month forever. Please be as specific as you can stand to be.

If you only answer one section, make it this one.

Everything else in this document is about winning a merchant. This section is about the money that arrives afterwards, which is the actual business — and it is where software usually helps the most.

Q18 How do residuals reach you each month, and in what format?

A CSV you download from a portal, a spreadsheet emailed to you, a PDF, a report you log in to read on screen? And roughly what day of the month?

Q19 How many separate reports do you reconcile each month, and do they agree with each other?

Q20 How are splits decided, and how often do they change?

A flat percentage per rep? Per merchant? Tiered on volume? Does a rep's split change when they hit a number, or when an account is handed over?

Q21 Describe what actually happens today, step by step, from the report landing to the reps being paid.

Who does it, in what tool, and how many hours does it take? If it is a spreadsheet, we would love a copy with the names blanked out — that one file would tell us more than this whole page.

Q22 Do your reps get a statement showing how their number was arrived at? Do they trust it?

And how often do they come back and argue with it? We are trying to work out whether a self-serve rep statement is worth building early.

06 Statements and pricing

How a rate gets proposed in the first place.

Q23 When a rep brings back a merchant's current processing statement, what happens to it?

Who works out the effective rate, in what tool, and how long does the rep wait before they can go back with a number?

Q24 Which pricing models do you offer?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Interchange plus | ☐ Cash discount |
| ☐ Tiered | ☐ Surcharge |
| ☐ Flat rate | ☐ Dual pricing |

Do you present more than one side by side, or arrive with a single recommendation?

Q25 Roughly how many statements does your office analyse in a normal week, and is that number limited by demand or by capacity?

07 Sensitive data

A short section, but we would rather ask than assume.

Q26 What sensitive information would you want stored in the system, and what should never touch it?

Applications contain Social Security numbers, tax IDs and bank details. Some offices want those held; others deliberately keep them only in the processor's portal. Card numbers we will not store under any circumstances. Tell us where your line is and we will design to it.

08 What you look at

Q27 What numbers do you check every week, and what do you check every month?

New accounts boarded, volume, attrition, rep performance, residual per account — and which one, if it moved the wrong way, would ruin your week?

09 Where AI could help

We would rather build the two things you would use daily than ten you would not. Please rank only the ones you care about — 1 for the most useful — and leave the rest blank.

Q28 Rank what would genuinely save you time.

WHAT IT WOULD DO	RANK
Read a competitor's statement for you A rep photographs the merchant's current statement; the volume, transaction count, fees and effective rate come back filled in.	
Draft the proposal from that statement Two or three priced options against their current cost, ready for the rep to adjust and present.	
Warn you when a merchant is slipping away Flags accounts whose volume has dropped sharply, before they close — so someone can call while it still matters.	
Check the processor's residual math Compares what you were paid against what the accounts should have produced, and flags the gaps.	
Brief a rep before a visit One short summary of the merchant: history with you, open issues, what was quoted last time, what to watch for.	
Write up a visit from the rep talking The rep speaks for thirty seconds in the car; the notes, the follow-up tasks and the deal's new stage are recorded for them.	
Pre-check an application before underwriting Flags a business type or a detail likely to be declined, before the paperwork is done.	
Answer the questions merchants repeat Deposit timing, what a fee is, how a chargeback works — drafted for your support person, or answered directly.	

Q29 What did you picture when you heard we were building AI into this?

Genuinely open. If you have seen something elsewhere that impressed you — or something that was sold as AI and turned out to be nothing — we would like to hear about both.

Q30 What should a computer never do on its own in your business?

Send something to a merchant unreviewed? Change a rate? Move a deal forward? Knowing your limits up front is how we avoid building something you would have to switch off.

10 What you use today

Q31 What software is your office in every day, and which of it would you happily stop paying for?

CRM, spreadsheets, e-signature, the processors' portals, accounting, phones, email marketing. Please mark anything we would need to connect to rather than replace.

Q32 If we could fix exactly one thing in the next ninety days, what should it be?

One sentence. This is the answer that sets our order of work.

Thank you — this is more useful than you think. Send it back however is easiest: typed, scanned, photographed, or read out to us on a call while someone takes notes. If you can attach one redacted residual spreadsheet and one merchant statement you have analysed recently, those two files will answer half of these questions better than writing ever could.